

Costume Design Guild

Digital fashion



Imara van der Wel
Guild session 3

My master research

- Running these guilds as part of my master research
- Needs to be recorded for documentation

Block B:

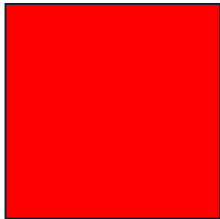
- Test runs of “workshop” set-up
- Practise teaching
- **Fashion content**
- In-person only

Block C:

- “Real” runs of my research
- Data gathering
- **Costume content (for games)**
- In-person but also streamed

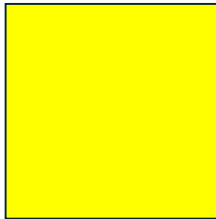
Explanation of my master research, how these guilds contribute to my research and testrun this block
And topic and focus of next block

PRE-SESSION QUESTIONS



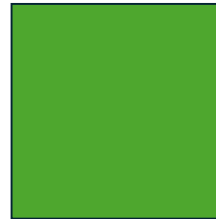
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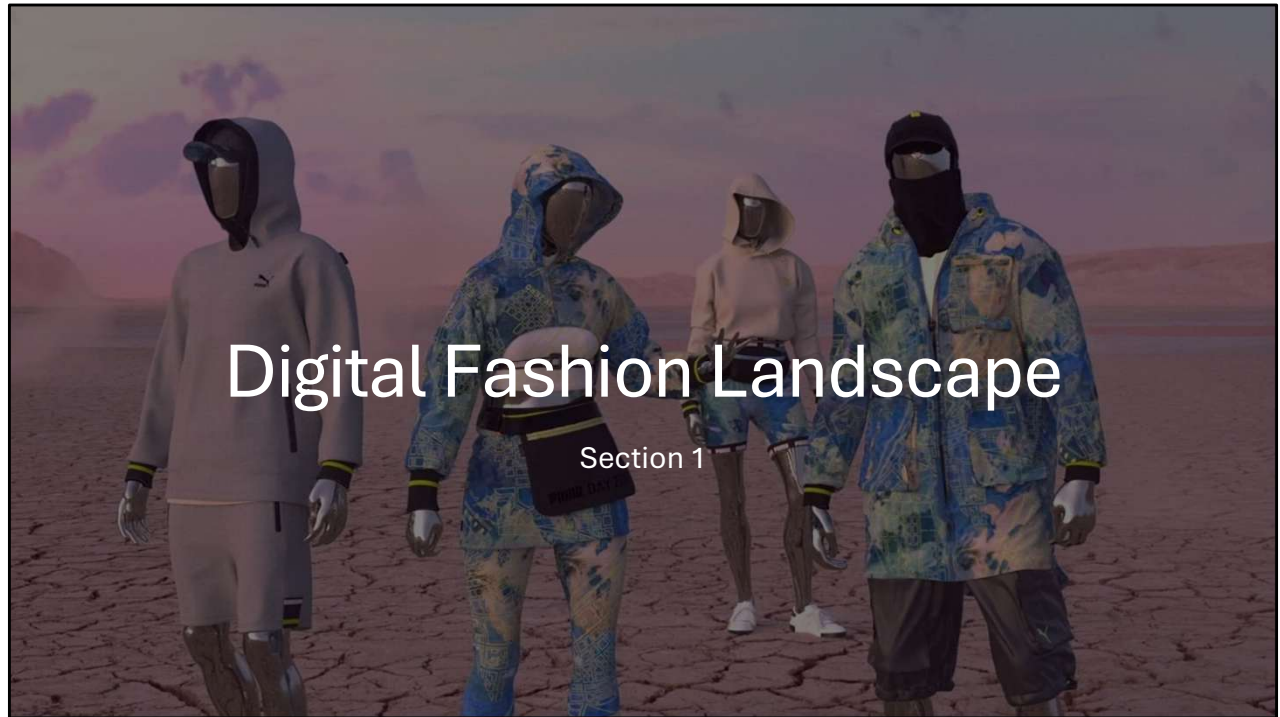
Agenda

1. Digital fashion landscape
 - Marketing
 - Social media / AR
 - Experimental designers
2. Live demo
3. Costume vs fashion in games
4. Activity



The agenda for this guild

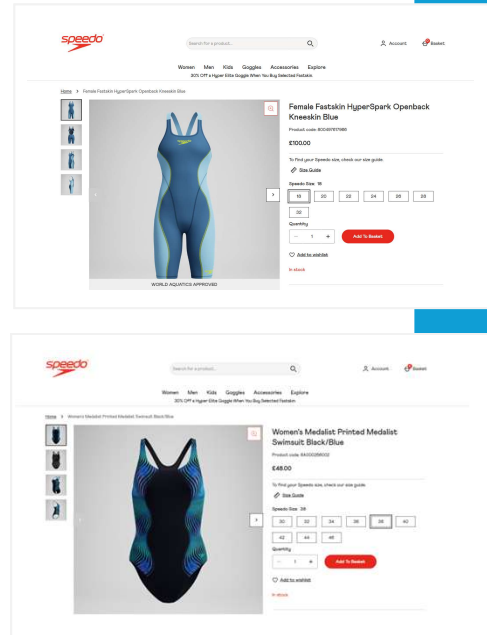
Image by Stephy fung



Let's talk about the digital fashion landscape, the different purposes of digital fashion

Marketing & Production Digital Fashion

- E-commerce without photoshoots
- Digital sampling saves time/money/material waste
- Fit verification before manufacturing



First purpose I want to talk about is something you probably have seen before which is digital fashion for marketing and production purposes

This process creates images for ecommerce without the need for real life models, garments and photoshoots

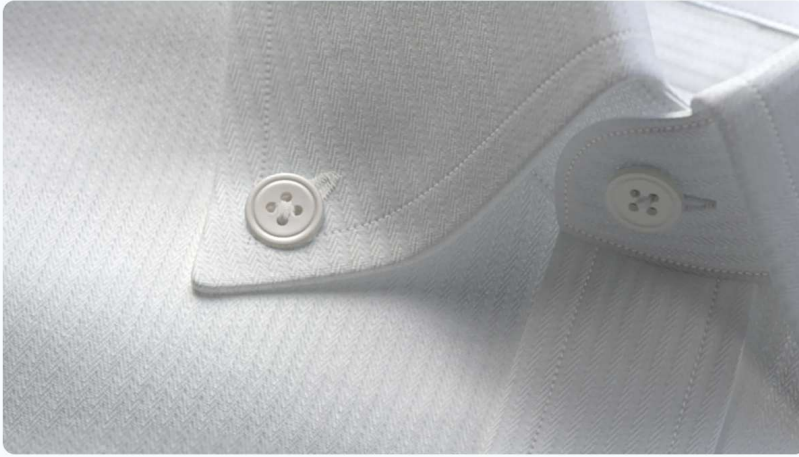
Sampling happens digitally which saves time, money and material waste.

Because unaccepted samples get thrown away

With digital sampling you can get verification of the fit before manufacturing, so problems can already be fixed

Here are two examples of the swimwear brand speedo which did the product images completely digitally for their collection

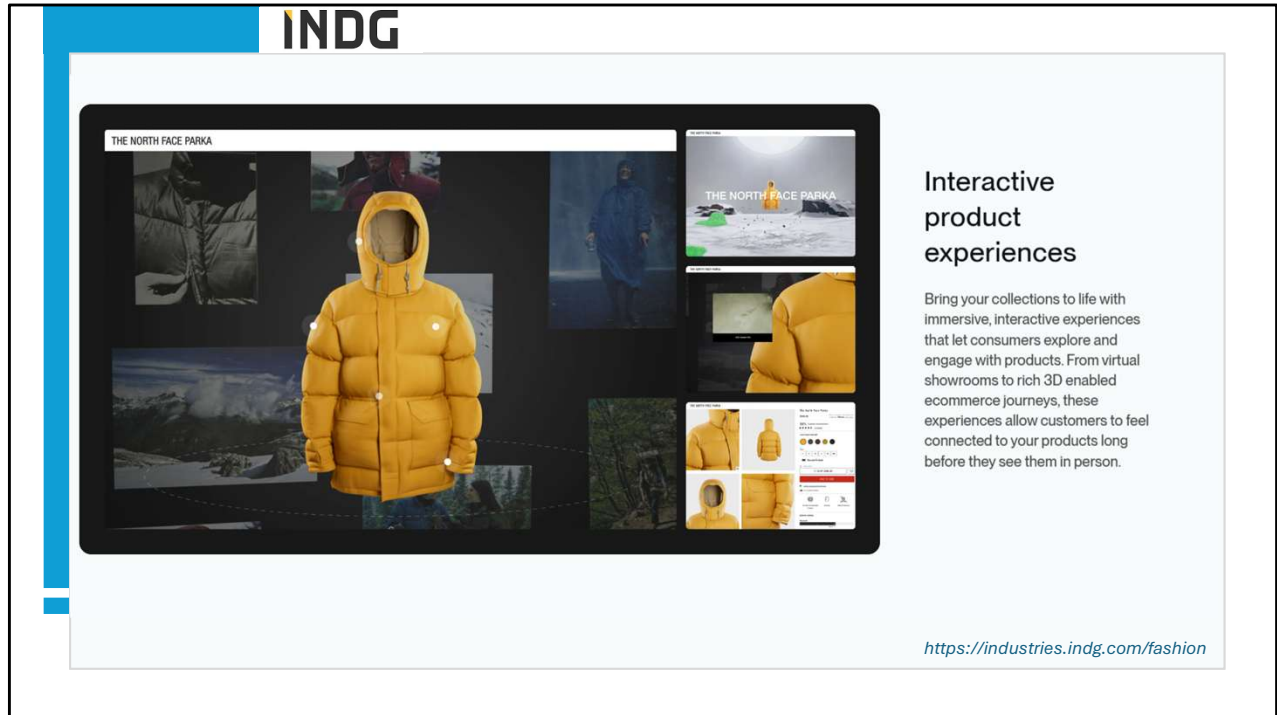
INDG



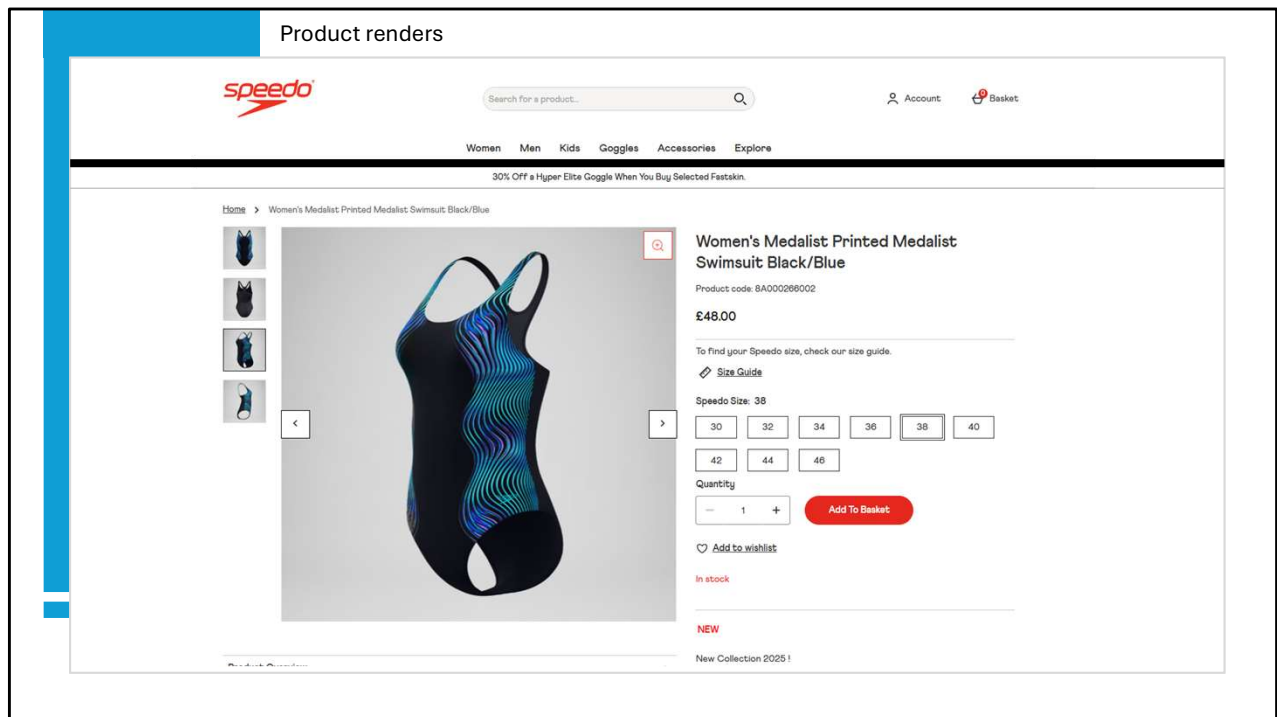
Ecommerce elevated

Elevate your ecommerce presence with photorealistic digital twins that showcase every detail of your product portfolio. Our high-quality image variations ensure consistent visuals across platforms, speeding up market entry and delivering a superior online shopping experience.

INDG is one of the biggest companies doing this for costumers and are based in the Netherlands, Amsterdam
They elevate ecommerce by creating photorealistic digital twins



Another example is north face, INDG made this interactive product experience for them where all details were highlighted in an immersive and interactive customer experience



Here is speedo again, as you can see, through digital sampling its very easy to render different sides of the product, instantly



Hugo boss had digital lookbooks made, showcasing their suits
These look super realistic, one trick to spot this is uniformity, you cant achieve
this sameness in every picture through real photoshoots

Digital colourway animations



Video

BOSS
HUGO BOSS

Digital colourway videos are also a cool way to show off the product, here hugo boss



Another example is this product portfolio visualisation by new era. Also made by INDG

Digital product renders



Shoes are also something that is often digitally rendered for cool videos and ecommerce images

Innovative / Experimental Digital Fashion

- Materials that don't exist, physics that don't apply
- Digital-only garments, AR filters, virtual worlds
- Fashion as pure visual/conceptual art



Materials that don't exist, physics that don't apply

- Unique looks that are impossible in real life for social media or metaverse purposes

Digital-only garments, AR filters, virtual worlds

- New ways for self-expression in hybrid and virtual worlds
- Boosting brand efficiency and marketing

Fashion as pure visual/conceptual art

- Opens new creative frontiers
- Source image: <https://www.showstudio.com/news/institute-of-digital-fashion-teams-up-with-hm-on-virtual-wearables>

AR filters



^Video



AR filters (snapchat) are also something in the digital fashion realm



During COVID digital fashion for social media arose
You can pay companies to photoshop digital garment on to an image of you
The purpose of this is preventing clothing being bought for just 1 Instagram
image, and then thrown away again
So “hiring” digital clothes makes the one-time-use of outfits more sustainable

Digital fashion for games



- *Fortnite*
- *Sims*
- *Roblox*
- *League of legends*

Real world brands collaborate with games like Fornite, but also sims, roblox, league of legends to advertise their brand to the younger generation

Digital fashion brand



AUROBOROS



Here are some examples of digital fashion brands

Here Auroboros, a brand specialised in unique digital fashion, you can buy these garments (suuuuper expensive) to get them photoshopped onto you

They also sold some real garment, and do AR filters and NFT's



THE FABRICANT



The Fabricant is another big digital fashion brand, they are Amsterdam based and got a lot of attention during the COVID period. They did a bunch with the NFT hype and now have an AI digital fashion render engine



Artist: Minh Thuan – 888Vampires

This independent designer makes futuristic garments with houdini

Source: <https://red-eye.world/c/meet-888vampires-the-limitless-potential-of-digital-fashion-in-an-interview-with-red-eye>

Digital fashion artist



Artist: Suza Vos

This is from someone who worked at the fabricant before but now lecture at my bachelors university, makes some cool alien stuff

Source: <https://www.blauwfilms.com/spotlight/012-suza-vos>

Digital fashion artist



Artist: Stephy Fung

Here Stephy Fung again, currently very popular on social media if you want to get into digital fashion

She does tutorials and streams her process on twitch

Source: <https://www.behance.net/gallery/238806059/Ruby-Moss>

Digital fashion artist



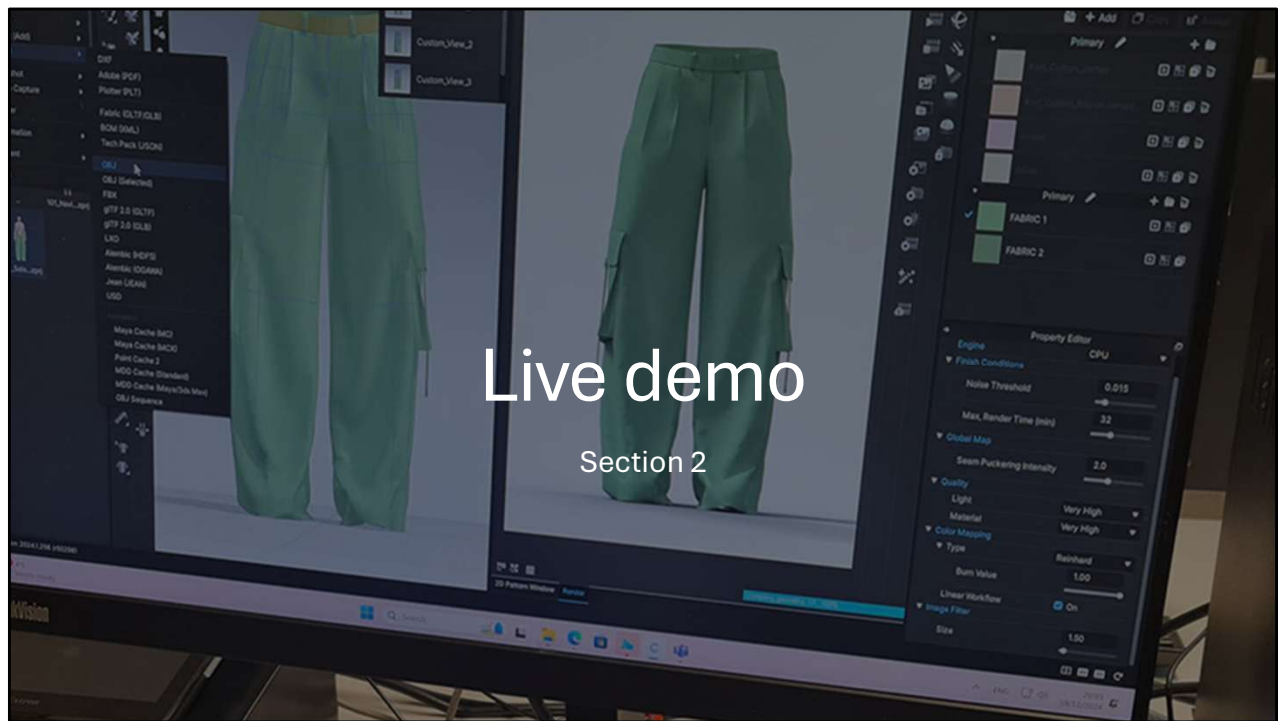
Artist: Deadstockbloom

And this is one of my favourite designers, she picks a topic and then creates 3 outfits using traditional sewing methods digitally

Source: <https://www.blauwfilms.com/spotlight/009-patricia-nahorniac>



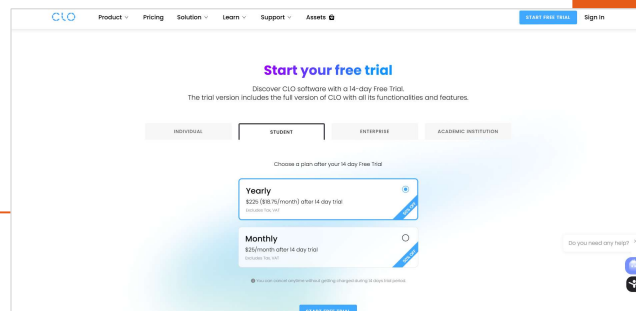
Source: <https://www.harpersbazaararabia.com/fashion/deus-ex-machina-digital-artists-take-over-harpers-bazaar-arabia-the-future-photoshoot>



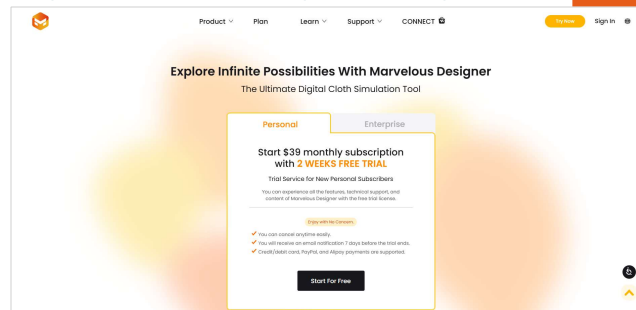
Download a trial Marvelous or Clo

At the end of this guild, we will be trying out Clo3D or Marvelous Designer.

Download it now so it's ready later



<https://www.clo3d.com/en/plans/subscription>



<https://www.marvelousdesigner.com/product/trial>

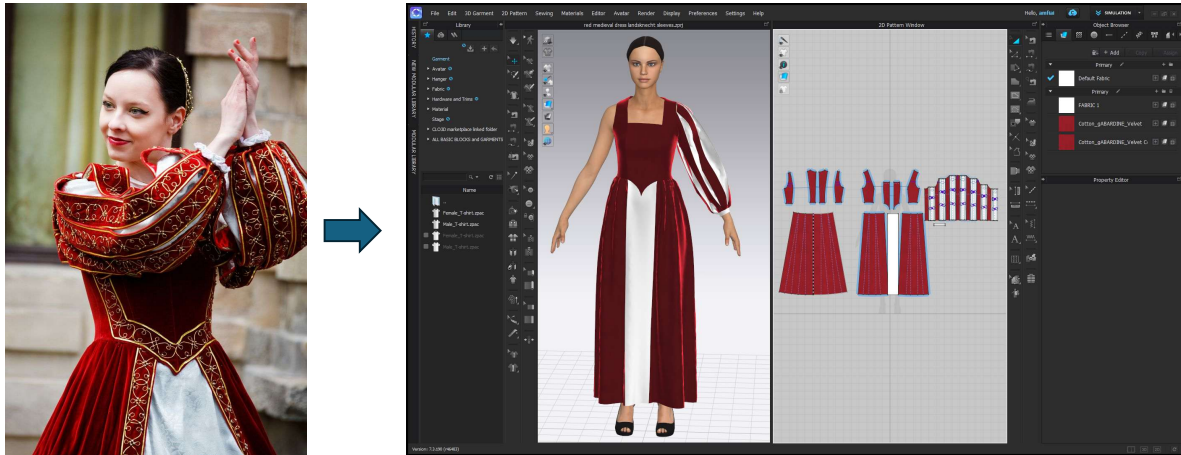
I gave the students the options:

- 1 download the trial so we can experiment at the end of the lesson together
- 2 or I take more time for the live demonstration of reference image to 3D garment

We chose to do option 2 as downloading the trial requires entering your credit card details

5. LIVE DEMO (10-12 min) ★ *Theory breaker*

- Create garment from basic block in CLO3D
- Narrate construction decisions
- Show how real knowledge translates to digital tools



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- Narrate construction decisions
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Gaming Connection: Fashion vs Costume

Section 3

And for our last topic I want to tell you about some connections to gaming



Fortnite X Balenciaga

Fashion vs costume

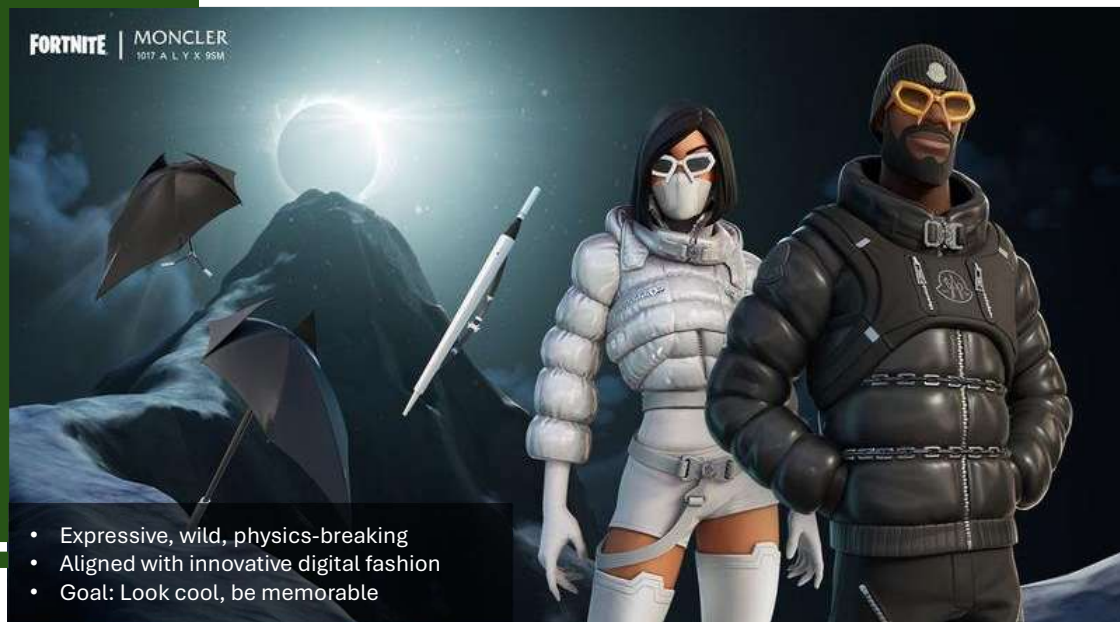
- Self expression • Character specific
- Trend following • Narrative driven
- Mass appeal • Fictional context
- Customizations • Predefined appearance

Horizon Zero Dawn



So in garments for gaming there's a clear difference in fashion and costume outfits.
See the bullet points

Fashion in games



- Expressive, wild, physics-breaking
- Aligned with innovative digital fashion
- Goal: Look cool, be memorable

Again, Fortnite, which uses outfits that are expressive, wild and physics breaking. These are aligned with innovative digital fashion and the goal for these is to look cool and be memorable.

Fashion in games



Fortnite



Pokémon Go



Animal Crossing

High fashion brands are putting outfits in video games to reach younger, digitally-native audiences (Gen Z/Alpha) who spend significant time in virtual worlds, tap into the booming virtual goods market, build cultural relevance, offer new creative expression for avatars, and bridge the gap between digital and physical fashion.

Costume in games



Storytelling games like horizon zero dawn and the last of us

Grounded, narrative-driven

Wear patterns, material believability

Goal: Support character and world

Where does construction knowledge matter?

Costume in games



Baldur's gate



The Last of Us



Metal Gear Solid

Here are some “good” costume design examples

These are good because they are recognizable, show what the character is for job/place in their world

And offer glimpses into their personality

Costume in games

Metal Gear Solid



Xenoblade chronicles 2

He's supposed
to be a diver??



Resident Evil



Here are some costume designs that missed the nail
There is definitely space for improvement in terms of storytelling alignment,
clearer design choices
and making the character recognizable in terms of their job, background, story
etc

Where does construction knowledge matter?

Garment knowledge matters for...

- Silhouette accuracy
- Wrinkle logic
- Cloth simulation
- Animation & rigging compatibility
- Texturing realism
- Worldbuilding depth
- Character storytelling
- Problem-solving for the whole pipeline



Supermassive Games – The Dark
Pictures Anthology: Little hope

So where does construction knowledge matter?
With some construction knowledge you can get:

- Silhouette accuracy
- Wrinkle logic
- Cloth simulation
- Animation & rigging compatibility
- Texturing realism
- Worldbuilding depth
- Character storytelling
- Problem-solving for the whole pipeline

Where does construction knowledge matter?

This creates:

- Clothing that feels grounded, even in speculative worlds
- Clothing ready for next-gen games
- Intentional design instead of decorative



CD Projekt Red - Cyberpunk 2077

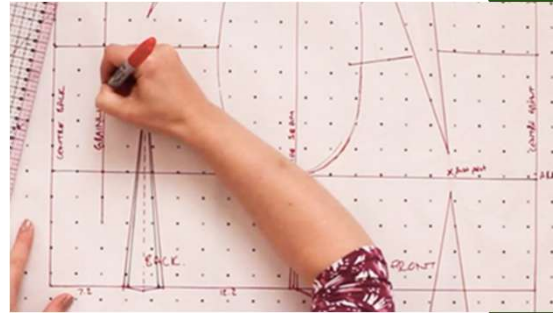


Supermassive Games – The Dark
Pictures Anthology: Little hope

When you can use construction knowledge to make deliberate decisions you can create clothing that feels, grounded even in fantasy/not real worlds
Your garments can be ready for next-gen games, which constantly improve in quality and skillset needed
And you can design intentionally instead of only decoratively

Connections to Previous Guilds

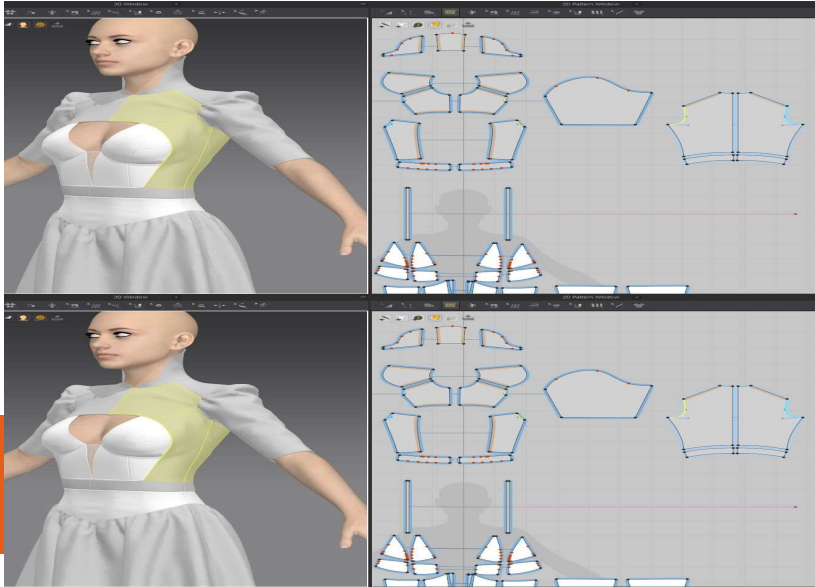
- Guild 1: Pattern construction
= what's behind the scenes
- Guild 2: Fabric properties
= digital parameters
- Start from real knowledge
→ then push beyond reality



The connection to previous guilds is that pattern construction tells you what happens behind the scenes of garment creation

Fabric properties give you digital parameters for silhouettes, drape and storytelling details, like the natural dying

So it all starts from (some) real knowledge, and then pushes beyond reality



Note:
*We skipped this
activity during class.*

*The students chose
for me to do a more
in-depth live demo*

Activity

Marvelous or CLO3D
exploration

Activity timeline

Setup (2 min)

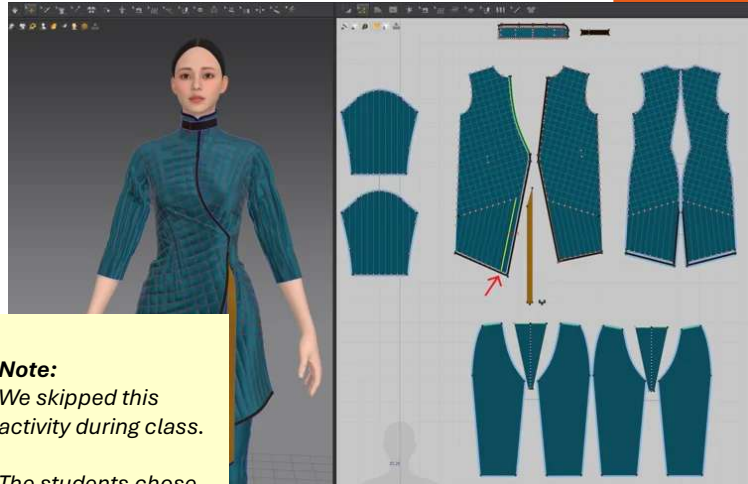
- Open MD or CLO

Activity Time (30-40 mins)

- Load in an avatar
- Load in some basic blocks
- Simulate
- Redesign

Debrief / group Share (3 min)

- What did you notice?
- What helped?
- What was confusing?

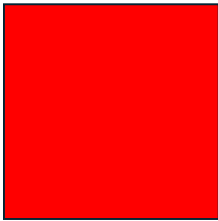


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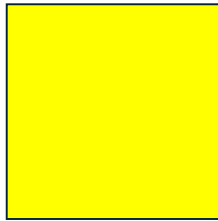
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bonus

Was this workshop useful for your practice?

Can you apply this to your own work?

Thanks for joining,
hope to see you next **Block!**

Possible topics:

- Historical and cultural exploration
- Semiotic analysis: elements as information
- Storytelling through props and accessories
- Period accurate seams, closures and fastenings
- Concepting through in-depth style sheets
- Silhouettes and visual stereotypes
- Draping vs tailoring
- Fabrics and construction details
- Colours, textures and prints



Thanks for joining!!! Let me know if there's a topic you would really want to see discussed!

Some topic examples that will be covered next block:

- Historical and cultural exploration
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